

Education

University of California, Davis

Davis, CA

PHD POLITICAL SCIENCE

2021-present

- Major Fields: International Relations; Comparative Politics
- Areas of Interest: Climate Politics; Political Economy; International Development; Foreign Aid; Survey Research; African Politics
- Dissertation: *Climate Shocks and Political Behavior Across Sub-Saharan Africa*
- Committee: Gabriella Montinola; Lauren Peritz; Daniel (Yuch) Kono
- Major Advisor: Gabriella Montinola

College of William & Mary

Williamsburg, VA

BA PUBLIC POLICY *with honors*

2014-2018

- Minor in Hispanic Studies
- Undergraduate Research Advisor: Dan Maliniak

Academic Experience

2021-2023;

2024-2025;

2026-

Present

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of California, Davis

2025-2026 **Pre-doctoral Fellow**, Global Climate Policy lab, Stanford University

2022-2024 **Graduate Student Researcher**, Environmental Science and Policy, University of California, Davis

Professional Experience

2022-2022 **Special Researcher for Environment and Energy**, Shapiro-Davis Pennsylvania Gubernatorial Transition Team

2021-2021 **Senior Research Associate**, Breakwater Strategy

2020-2021 **Research Manager**, WBA Research

2018-2020 **Data Reporting Specialist**, TargetSmart Communications

Research

WORKING PAPERS

Owens, F., Verley, D., Constantino, C., De la Cuesta, B., Kennard, A. Automated Survey Harmonization via Source-Consistent Entity Resolution. *Under Review*.

Owens, F., Climate Shocks and Protest in Nigeria

Owens, F., De la Cuesta, B. Competitive Climate: Climate Shocks and the Strategic Expansion of Vote buying in Africa.

Owens, F., Green Aid and Chinese Soft Power in Africa.

Owens, F., Montinola, G. Rewarding Ambitious Climate Pledges.

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Owens, F., de la Cuesta, B. Competitive Climate: Climate Shocks and the Strategic Expansion of Vote buying in Africa. Presented at the American Political Science Association Conference. 2025.

Owens, F., Green Aid and Chinese Soft Power in Africa. Presented at the American Political Science Association Conference. 2024.

Owens, F., Green Aid and Chinese Soft Power in Africa. Presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference. 2024.

Owens, F., Montinola, G. Rewarding Ambitious Climate Pledges. Presented at the Western Political Science Association Conference. 2023.

Owens, F., Parajon, E. Climate Change, Sea Level Rise, and City Preparation. Presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference. 2018.

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026	Dean's Graduate Summer Support Award , University of California, Davis	\$ 6,000
2025	Pre-doctoral Fellowship , Stanford University	\$ 63,000
2025	Faculty-Graduate Student Summer Collaborative , University of California, Davis	\$ 5,000
2025	Living Expense Fellowship , University of California, Davis	\$ 3,000
2024	APSA Travel Grant , University of California, Davis	\$ 1,000
2023	Conference Travel Grant , University of California, Davis	\$ 1,000
2022	Faculty-Graduate Student Summer Collaborative , University of California, Davis	\$ 5,000
2018	Undergraduate Travel Grant , College of William & Mary	\$ 500

Teaching Experience

Spring 2025;	Intro to International Relations , Teaching Assistant and Section Leader	<i>UC Davis</i>
Winter 2025		
Fall 2024	Scientific Study of War , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Summer 2024	Mass Media & Politics , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Winter 2023	International Law , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Fall 2022	Global Inequality , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Spring 2022	Politics and Inequality , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Winter 2022	Politics of Sports , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>

Mentoring

2021-2022 **Kieran Cabezas**, Student, UC Davis

Languages

Native: English **Fluent:** Spanish

References

Gabriella Montinola, Professor, UC Davis grmontinola@ucdavis.edu

Lauren Peritz, Associate Professor, UC Davis lperitz@ucdavis.edu

Daniel (Yuch) Kono, Professor Emeritus, UC Davis dykono@ucdavis.edu

Brandon de la Cuesta, Research Scientist, Stanford University *brandon.delacuesta@stanford.edu*